

between the core and crust of a planet or moon.

Matter

Something that exists as a solid, liquid, or gas.

Meteor

A streak of light, also called a shooting star, seen when a chunk of space rock burns up due to friction on entering Earth's atmosphere.

Meteorite

A chunk of space rock that reaches the ground and survives impact.

Milky Way

The barred spiral galaxy that contains the Solar System and is visible to the naked eye as a band of faint light across the night sky.

Module

A portion of a spacecraft.

Nebula

A cloud of gas and dust in space.

Neutron star

A dense, collapsed star that is mainly made of neutrons.

Nuclear fusion

A process in which atomic nuclei join to form a heavier nucleus and release large amounts of energy.

Orbit

The path taken by an object around another when affected by its gravity.

Orbiter

A spacecraft designed to orbit an object but which is not designed to land on it.

Payload

Cargo or equipment, such as a satellite or space telescope, carried into space by a rocket or spacecraft.

Planet

A spherical object that orbits a star and is sufficiently massive to have cleared its orbital path of debris.

Planetary nebula

A glowing cloud of gas ejected by a star at the end of its life.

Probe

An unmanned spacecraft that is designed to explore objects in space and transmit information back to Earth.

Pulsar

A neutron star that sends out beams of radiation as it spins.

Quasar

Short for "quasi-stellar radio source", a quasar is the immensely luminous nucleus of a distant active galaxy with

a supermassive black hole at its centre.

Red giant

A large, luminous star with a low surface temperature and a reddish colour, nearing the final stages of its life.

Rover

A vehicle that is driven remotely on the surface of a planet or a moon.

Satellite

An object that orbits a planet.

Soviet Union

A group of countries occupying the northern half of Asia and part of eastern Europe formed after the Russian revolution in 1917. The Soviet Union was dissolved in 1991.

Spacewalk

Activity by an astronaut in space outside a spacecraft, usually to conduct repairs or test equipment.

Star

A huge sphere of glowing gas that generates energy by nuclear fusion in its core.

White dwarf

A small, hot, dense star, the core of a red giant that has shed its atmosphere as a planetary nebula.